TITUS

Conversational Version

Salutation

1:1 Paul, servant of God and apostle of Jesus Christ[Messiah] for the faith God's chosen *people* have, and for the knowledge of the truth that leads to godliness and **2**hope for eternal life. God our Savior, who doesn't lie, promised that life before times eternal. **3**Then at an appropriate time, he made the message available by the preaching he entrusted to me according to the commandment of our Savior God. **4**To Titus, *my* loyal son in the faith we share. Grace and peace from God the Father and Christ Jesus our Savior. **Tit 1:1-4**

Characteristics of Elders

5I left you in Crete to arrange what still needed to be done and to appoint elders in every city like I instructed you. **6**A man needs to be above criticism, faithful to his wife, whose children aren't accused of reckless living or disobedience—**7**because a bishop needs to be above criticism as God's steward. *He must* not *be* stubborn, quick-tempered, addicted to wine, violent, or greedy for dishonest gain. **8***He needs to be* hospitable, loving what's good, sensible, just, self-controlled. **9***He needs to* hold on tight to the trustworthy message he was taught. That way he can encourage *people* in sound doctrine and show the error of the ones that speak falsely. **Tit 1:5-9**

Silencing Disorderly People

10There are lots of disorderly people, empty talkers, and deceivers, especially from the Circumcision, **11**that need to be silenced. They overthrow whole families by teaching things people don't need to do, and they do it dishonestly to make money. **12**One of their own prophets has said, *"Cretans are always liars, bad animals, lazy gluttons."* **13**That's true; so reprimand them sharply to make them sound in the faith, **14**not caught up in Jewish myths and human rules that distract people from the truth. **15**Everything's pure to people that are pure; nothing's pure to people that are not pure. They've defiled their minds and consciences. **16**They claim to know God, but they deny *it* by how they act. They're detestable, disobedient, and worthless for doing anything good. **Tit 1:10-16**

Older Christian's Decorum

2:1 But you, encourage the kind of living that is appropriate to sound doctrine. **2**Older men should be serious-minded, respectable, sensible; sound in faith, love, and endurance. **3**The same thing applies to older women. They should be reverent in behavior, not prone to gossip or addicted to wine, *but* teaching what's good. **4**Then they can teach young women to love their husbands and children. **5**They *should be* sensible, pure, devoted to their families, kind, *and* deferring to their husbands so people won't slander God's message. **Tit 2:1-5**

Young Men's Decorum

6 In the same way, *encourage* younger men to be sensible. 7 Present yourself as an
example of doing good. *Demonstrate* pure doctrine, respectable conduct, 8 and sound speech that
people can't criticize. Then critics will be ashamed because they can't find anything bad to say
about you. **Tit 2:6-8**

Salvation Offered to Everybody

9 *Urge* servants to submit to their masters, to be pleasing, not argumentive, 10 not stealing,
but showing good faith so they can adorn the doctrine of God our Savior. **Tit 2:9-10**

11 God's grace has appeared and offered salvation to everyone. 12 His grace instructs us to
set aside ungodliness and worldly pleasures and to live wisely, justly, and godly in the present
age. 13 All the while, we look forward to the blessed hope, the glorious appearing of our great
God and Savior Jesus Christ. 14 He gave himself to redeem us from lawlessness and to purify a
special people for himself, *a people* with zeal zeal for doing good. 15 Speak these things, urge,
and reprimand with authority. Don't let anybody disregard you. **Tit 2:11-15**

Respecting Earthly Rulers

3:1 Remind *people* to submit to rulers and authorities, to be obedient and ready to do
everything that's good. 2 *Remind them* not to insult or get pushy, *but* to be considerate and gentle
toward everybody. 3 At one time we were foolish too, disobedient, deceived, addicted to various
lusts and pleasures. We spent our lives in evil and envy, hated and hating one another. 4 But,

> *"the kindness of God our Savior appeared along with love for* other *people.* 5 *We*
> *didn't save ourselves by doing good. In mercy* <u>*he*</u> *saved us by the washing that*
> *regenerates and by the renewal the Holy Spirit* gives. 6 God *poured out his Spirit*
> *on us richly through Jesus Christ our Savior.* 7 *In grace he justified us so we could*
> *inherit the hope for eternal life."* **Tit 3:1-7**

8 That's a reliable statement. I want you to emphasize doing these things so the ones that
have believed God will concentrate on doing good. *Such things* are good and profitable. 9 But,
avoid foolish controversies, genealogies, rivalries, legal disputes; they're pointless and
unprofitable. 10 After a first and second warning, quit having anything to do with people who
cause division. 11 They're perverted sinners that have condemned themselves. **Tit 3:8-11**

Plans for Further Ministry

12 When Artemas or Tychycus get to you—that I'm sending—do your best to meet me at
Nicopolis. I've decided to spend the winter there. 13 Diligently help Zenas the lawyer and Apollos

get on their way with what they need. **14**Have our *people* learn to practice doing good to meet pressing needs so they'll be productive.

15The ones that are with me greet you. Greet those who love us in the faith.

Grace *be* with you all. **Tit 3:12-15**

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